

IN PRINCIPIO

WEDDINGS BY KIM & IVAN

a quick start companion to your

Pose Reference Pack

NIKON EDITION

inprincioweddings.com

i.

Welcome

Thank you for choosing this pack. What follows is everything you need to move it from a file on your computer to a working part of your camera; it should take about three minutes the first time you do it.

The pack you've downloaded is a small set of JPEG image files prepared specifically for Nikon Z bodies. Each image carries a posing reference, a short prompt to use with the couple, and a framing note. The files were built and tested on real cameras (Z8 and Z9) so that, once they are on a memory card, your camera treats them as ordinary photos and lets you scroll through them on the back screen the same way you would your own work.

No app. No phone. No signal. Just the camera you're already holding.

A note before you begin

Each camera brand stores JPEGs in its own way, and files prepared for one brand are not portable to another. This pack is for Nikon Z bodies only. If you mainly shoot Sony, Canon, Fujifilm, or anything else, write to us before you set up so we can confirm whether a build for your body exists yet.

The instructions on the following pages assume the same conditions we tested under: a clean memory card, formatted in the camera, plus a moment with the card in your computer to copy files across. Nothing exotic.

ii.

Set up the memory card

The pack needs to live in the folder Nikon cameras expect to find photos in. This is a one-time setup; afterwards, you only touch the card again to swap references in or out.

Format the card

- 1** Insert the memory card into your camera (your primary slot if you shoot dual-card; the pack works the same on a CFexpress or an SD card).
- 2** Open **MENU** → **Setup menu (wrench)** → **Format memory card**, choose the slot, and confirm.
- 3** Take one ordinary photo; a wall, a coffee cup, anything. This is what makes the camera create the **DCIM/100NCZ_...** folder the pack needs.
- 4** Power the camera down and take the card out.

IF THE FOLDER ALREADY EXISTS. *If you're working with a card that has been used in this Nikon before, the **DCIM/100NCZ_...** folder is probably already there. You can skip the format and the test photo entirely; just back up whatever you'd like to keep, since the next step adds files to that folder.*

ii. continued

Copy the files across

Once the card has a folder Nikon recognises, the rest is a straight file-copy step. A card reader does this more reliably than connecting the camera over USB.

- 1** Connect the memory card to your computer with a card reader. Avoid plugging the camera itself in over USB; some bodies lock the file system in ways that can confuse what comes next.
- 2** Unzip the pack you downloaded. Inside you'll find the **DSC_XXXX.JPG** reference files.
- 3** Open the card's **DCIM** folder. You'll see a folder your camera created with a name like **100NCZ_8** or **100NCZ_9**. Drop every **DSC_XXXX.JPG** from the pack into that folder.
- 4** If the computer asks whether to replace a file, choose Replace; this happens only if your test photo and one of the pack files share a filename, and the replacement is a clean overwrite.
- 5** Eject the card cleanly. On Mac: click the eject arrow next to the card in Finder, or press **⌘E**. On Windows: use Safely Remove Hardware.

IMPORTANT. *Copy only the JPEG files; not the ZIP itself, not this PDF, not any other folders. The camera can be confused by anything other than image files inside **DCIM**.*

WHY THE FOLDER NAME DIFFERS. *Nikon names that first folder after the body: a Z8 creates **100NCZ_8**, a Z9 creates **100NCZ_9**, the Z6 line **100NCZ_6**, the Z7 line **100NCZ_7**. Always copy the references into the one your own camera made; that's the folder it reads back on playback.*

iii.

On shoot day

The pack lives on the memory card as ordinary photos. There is no app to open, no menu to navigate to; everything works through the same playback controls you already use.

- 1** Insert the card and power the camera on.
- 2** Press the Playback button (▶). The pack appears in the gallery alongside any shoot photos already on the card.
- 3** Scroll through with the multi-selector or the main command dial.
- 4** Press up or down on the multi-selector to hide the camera's data overlay and see each reference full-screen.
- 5** To leave playback and go back to shooting, half-press the shutter.

IN PRACTICE. *Some photographers leave the camera in playback between frames and only exit when ready to release the shutter. The reference stays on screen until the shutter is pressed, so it can stay open while you direct the couple.*

If the pack doesn't appear

Nikon Z bodies pick the pack up the moment the card goes in — there's no rebuild-database step to run. If the references don't show, the usual cause is that the camera is set to play back only its most recent folder: open **PLAYBACK MENU** → **Playback folder** and set it to **All**, so every folder on the card is shown. Beyond that, the cause is almost always something on the card itself — see the troubleshooting page for the short list.

Carrying only what you need

The pack works best when the card holds only the references that fit the day in front of you. For a wedding you may pull thirty or forty across getting-ready, ceremony, and portraits; for a portrait session, less. Keep the master pack unzipped on your computer and treat the memory card as a working space you re-arrange between sessions.

iv.

Care, troubles, and how to reach us

Most issues come down to one of two things: the files weren't copied into the right folder, or the camera is set to show only its latest folder. Both take a minute to fix.

If something looks wrong on the camera

If the references don't show, or appear as corrupted images, walk back through this list:

- The files copied across are only **.JPG**; no ZIP, no folders, no other formats.
- They are inside the **100NCZ_...** folder your camera created (e.g. **100NCZ_8** or **100NCZ_9**), not loose in **DCIM**.
- **PLAYBACK MENU** → **Playback folder** is set to **All**, so the camera shows every folder rather than only the most recent.
- The card was ejected cleanly from the computer before going back into the camera; sudden disconnects can leave the file system half-written.

If the issue stays after all four checks, format the card in the camera again (after backing up anything you want to keep), take a fresh test photo, and re-copy the pack. A fresh format resolves almost every edge case.

If you'd like to reach us

The contact form on inprincipioweddings.com reaches us directly; the pack is small enough that personal replies are still the norm. The most useful thing you can include is your camera body and firmware version (**MENU** → **Setup menu (wrench)** → **Firmware version**), plus a short description of what's happening and a phone photo of the camera screen if you can.

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